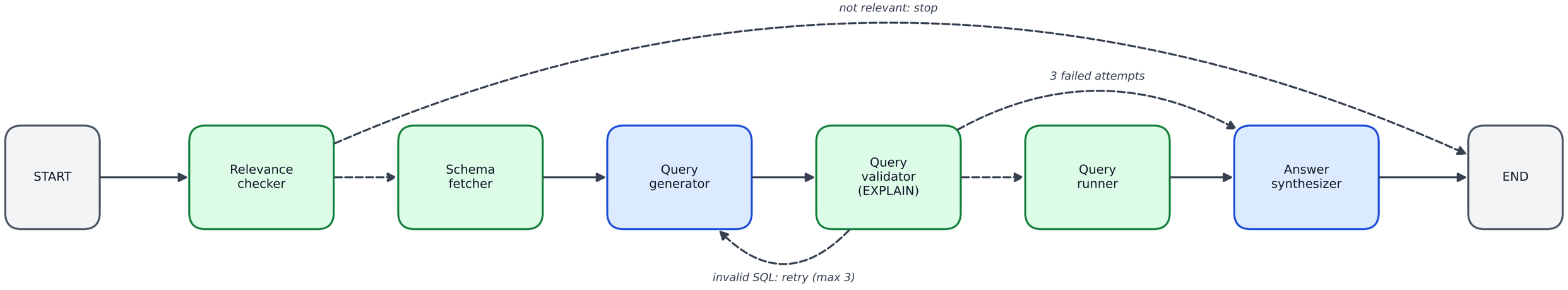agent_2: relevance check, EXPLAIN validation and up to 3 retries